

KaZaA as spyware is a delicate matter. CA admits that this creates difficulties in attaching labels.

Said Simon Perry, vice president of security strategy for CA, "Kazaa does something useful. I'm not going to say that it doesn't. But turn that around—you're allowing millions of strangers onto your machine. (KaZaA) is No 1 because of the amount if copies it's got out there."

Perry said that the difficulty in defining spyware precisely was one reason why the company often referred to certain programs as pests. He said that the definition of a virus is clear today, but "spyware" is a fuzzy area.

But what's in a label? Everyone who uses P2P

software already knows the risks involved, and it is an informed decision that makes them use the software.

10 MILLION DOWNLOADS

Firefox On A Sprint

Firefox, the open-source challenger to IE, crossed the 10-million-download mark on December 11.

As Mozilla expected, Web surfers are continuing to move away from Microsoft's market-dominating Internet Explorer. This milestone highlights growing frustration with the security vulnerabilities that have dogged IE in the past few

months. IE's market share has now dropped to less than 90 per cent: Dutch market researcher OneStat.com reported last month that IE's market share had slipped to 88.9 percent in the third week of November, down five percentage points from the figure in May. Mozilla-based browsers including Firefox rose to 7.4 percent, up five percentage points since May.

Microsoft has not remained silent about these numbers. It has claimed they do not represent corporate users. "It doesn't jibe with what WebSideStory shows, and what neither of these count is corporate intranets where users aren't actually hitting the Web," said Gary Schare, Microsoft's director of product management for Windows, about OneStat's statistics.

GOOGLEBRARY

Are You The New Librarian, Mr Google?

Adding to its already feathered hat, Google has announced that it will work with Stanford and Harvard Universities, amongst others, to digitise out-of-print and copyrighted works.

The California-based search giant announced relationships with five major libraries, including those at the University of Michigan and Oxford University, as well as the New York Public Library, to create digital copies of some books so that they may be searchable using Google. The company also began sampling some works already scanned for Google Print, the company's searchable index of books that it formally unveiled in October.

Susan Wojcicki, Google's director of product management, said the project will evolve over several years. "Libraries have been the keepers of information for

ON THE HORIZON



Talking To Your PC

"@#\$\$* Computer!"

The next big wave in person-to-machine interaction will take us beyond pounding on the keyboard and into the realm of natural voice interaction. The seed has already been sown; you can see signs in software such as the latest version of the Opera Web browser, which uses IBM's ViaVoice application. Ask it to speak out text for you, or speak to it and watch it fill online forms. This is rudimentary tech, however.

Imagine talking to your computer like we do with another person, a complete conversation beyond "yes," "no," and "reboot." Say you are driving around in your car and wish to go to Nehru Place, Delhi. You ask your car's computer to give you the necessary directions (which it finds via GPS), and the computer replies with spoken words. To help it "listen" better, over the ambient Delhi noise, cameras will track your lip movement, the computer will literally read your lips.

A big turn off about computer speech is, well, their voice—unnatural, metallic, cold. IBM is researching a simple solution for that as well. It creates samples of human speech, microseconds long, and weaves these snippets into "spoken" sentences which sound very close to the human thing. Moreover, far from coming off as uncaring when it declares "your PC is about to explode," IBM's tech uses "expressive synthesizers" which have a range of expressions—tonal variations to fit "good news" and "bad news" statements, for example.

Microsoft, too, is big on speech. In various offline forums, Bill Gates has singled out speech technology as something to look forward to. Indeed, Microsoft's next version of its operating system, meant for handhelds, is likely to incorporate speech recognition for both data input and

centuries," she said. "We are excited to unlock that wealth of information."

The scope of every relationship that Google would share with every institution,

GENDER

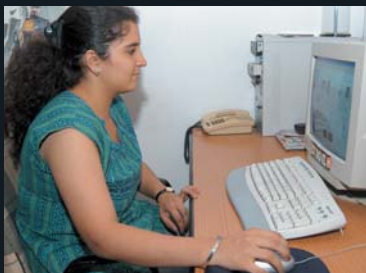


BENDERS

Taroon Ahooja vs Geetanjali Singh Delete the *My Documents* and *My Recent Documents* tabs from the Start Menu and put them back on.



A little doubtful, he manages to delete the *My Documents* tab in under 2 minutes time. But where is the *My Recent Documents* option? Searches high and low: Control Panel—Administrative Tools? Taskbar and Start Menu? Goes back to the Start Menu. Uses the much helpful Help and Support option. Types the question in the search bar and navigates his way to the solution. What a task!



She started off confidently, but did take some time to finish the task. First drags the two items and puts it on the Desktop, but alas, it's still in the Start Menu. The search begins....is it open? explore? what is it? Goes to Properties, but can't find the solution. Next stop—Control Panel. Ah! There is a *Taskbar and Start Menu* Option. Opens that, goes to Start Menu > Customise > Advanced. Bingo! There it is. Clicks 'Don't display this item' for *My Documents* and de-selects the tick for *Recent Documents*. Phew!